



## Irumudi Guidelines

Swamy Saranam! 🙏

Dear Swamies,

By the divine grace of **Lord Ayyappa**, as we approach the sacred Irumudi Kattu, please follow these humble guidelines to help prepare and participate with sincerity and devotion.

### ॐ Before Irumudi: Preparation Steps

#### 1. Registration:

- Please complete your **Irumudi registration** on the temple website <https://atlantaayyappatemple.org/irumudi.php>.
- Reach out to the **Temple Irumudi Coordinator** to confirm your **Irumudi timing** and other details.

#### 2. Day Before Irumudi:

- If you already have an Irumudi bag, **wash and clean it** properly.
- Visit the temple and **clean the Nei (Ghee) coconut** in advance.

### 🙏 On the Day of Irumudi

#### At Home:

- Perform your **daily morning pooja** as usual.
- Gather all your belongings before **breaking the coconut**.
- Break one coconut **outside your home** before leaving for the temple.
- Once the coconut is broken, **do not re-enter the house**.
- (Optional) You may bring a small amount of **rice, ghee, and fruits** to offer during the Irumudi preparation.

#### At the Temple:

- All **Irumudi items** will be provided at the temple.
- Arrive **15 minutes before the scheduled time**.
- The **Irumudi Kattu Niraithal** is an **auspicious and deeply spiritual ceremony** during the Ayyappa Mandala Vratham.



# ATLANTA AYYAPPA TEMPLE

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## Spiritual Significance:

The Irumudi represents **Ātma Samarpanam** — the surrender of one's soul to the Lord.

- The **coconut shell** symbolizes our **perishable body**,
- The **ghee within** represents the **pure, eternal soul (Ātma)**.  
By offering it to Lord Ayyappa, we surrender our inner self with devotion and humility.

During the Irumudi Kattu, let us all **chant sincerely**, keep **Lord Ayyappa in our thoughts**, and maintain **devotional silence and focus**.

## After the Irumudi is Tied:

- Once the Irumudi is placed on your forehead, proceed **outside the temple to break the coconut**, then **circumambulate** the temple and **break another coconut** before entering the Ayyappa Sannidhanam.
- If you are offering at another temple (e.g., Tampa), break the coconut outside, place the Irumudi reverently in your vehicle, and then proceed.
- During **Irumudi opening and Ghee offering**, maintain sincere **chanting and devotion**.
- **Turmeric and Kumkum powder** will be offered to **Sri Manjamatha**.
- Before leaving the temple, please **collect your Irumudi bag, rice, and ghee container**.

## After the Temple Visit:

- Upon returning home, **break a coconut outside** and then enter your **pooja room** to perform **Aarthi to Swamy**.
- Use the **rice from your Irumudi bag** to prepare a **sweet offering** (prasadam) for Lord Ayyappa, and **share it with your family and friends**.
- When removing your **Mala** (before **Harivarasanam** at the temple), keep it respectfully in a small **box or ziploc bag**, and sprinkle **Vibuthi or Chandanam** over it.
- Store it safely for future use.

## Additional Note:

Please continue to participate in all **Ayyappa temple poojas and bhajans** after your **Maladharana and Vratham**, as it helps sustain the divine connection and strengthens your spiritual journey.

**Swamy Saranam!**  **May Lord Ayyappa bless all Swamies with devotion, discipline, and divine grace throughout this sacred Mandala Vratham.**